

Technical Guide: Adapting the Database to a Local Environment

This guide explains how to configure the database connection settings for the FitTrack application in a local environment using the config.ini file.

1. Changing Connection Details

The application separates configuration from code using a config.ini file. To adapt the database connection to your local machine, follow these steps:

1. Locate the **config.ini** file in the project's root directory.
2. Open the file in any text editor.
3. Modify the values under the [mysql] section as follows:
 - **Host Name:** Change the host value. For local development, this is typically localhost.

Username: Change the user value to your local MySQL username (e.g., root).

Password: Change the password value to match your local database password

Database Name: Change the FitTrack_db value to the name of the database schema you created.

Verifying the Database Connection:

To ensure the database is working properly and the connection is successful:

1. **Ensure MySQL Service is Running:** Open your database management tool (e.g., MySQL Workbench or XAMPP) and verify that the MySQL server is active/green.
2. **Run the Application:** Start the Flask server by running the main entry point:

Python app.py

Check Console Logs: Look at the terminal output. If the connection is successful, the application will start without errors (typically showing Running on <http://127.0.0.1:5000>).

Troubleshooting:

- If you see an OperationalError or Access denied, verify that the **username** and **password** in config.ini match your MySQL credentials exactly.
- If you see Can't connect to MySQL server, verify the **host** and **port** (default is 3306).

